

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1336

By Farmer

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Sevier County High School Bearettes basketball team upon winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class 4A state championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of young ladies is the Bearettes girls' basketball team of Sevier County High School, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class 4A state championship; and

WHEREAS, after posting an undefeated record to win the 4A District 2 regular season championship, the Bearettes began postseason play by winning the 4A District 2 tournament and defeating Morristown East 46-40 to take the 4A Region 1 tournament crown to advance to Sectionals; and

WHEREAS, facing Farragut in the sectional contest, the Sevier County Bearettes posted a double-digit victory (61-45) to punch their ticket to The Glass House, home of the TSSAA Class 4A state tournament on the campus of Middle Tennessee State University in Murfreesboro; and

WHEREAS, as the competition toughened, so did the Bearettes; Sevier County faced the undefeated, nationally ranked, and three-time defending champions, Bradley Central High School, in the first round of the state tournament but scored a resounding 52-34 victory to advance to the semifinals; and

WHEREAS, in the semifinals, the Bearettes played the very big and athletic Blackman High School, which was ranked among the top five 4A schools in Tennessee, and held the Lady Blaze to just 26 points, to come out victorious in the thrilling matchup to claim the right to play for the Gold Ball trophy in the title game; and

WHEREAS, in the fight for the crown of state champions, the Sevier County Bearettes used their lock-down defense to hold the high-scoring Cookeville Lady Cavaliers to take the 61-43 victory and earn the second state championship in school history; and

WHEREAS, throughout the state tournament, the Sevier County Bearettes displayed a defensive tenacity that was unrivaled, holding their opponents to under 35 points per game and winning by an average of more than 15 points per contest; it was one of the most impressive and dominant defensive performances in TSSAA state tournament history; and

WHEREAS, Sevier County's superb performance would not have been possible without the expert guidance and assistance of Coach Jonathan Shultz; his assistants, PJ Burden and Heather Kelley; team managers, Adalyn Shultz, Tenley McFalls, and Brycen Burden; trainer, Eli Gass; bookkeeper, Jordan Jeffers; athletic director, Bryan Atchley, and principal, Dr. Mitchell Whaley, and the unfailing support of the players' families, fans, and community; and

WHEREAS, each Bearette player contributed significantly to the team's remarkable winning streak in route to the state title; these outstanding young ladies include Region All-Tournament selection Brylie Valentine, District All-Tournament selection Addison Brewer, regular season District MVP and District, Region, and State tournament MVP Kaliyah Burden, First Team All-District and Region and State All-Tournament selection Aubree Thompson, First Team All-District and District and State All-Tournament team selection Maggie Townsend, First Team All-District and Region and State All-Tournament selection Hannah Madison, Reagan Thomas, Hannah French, Gemma Osborne, and Maddie Hawkins; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Sevier County High School girls' basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Sevier County Bearettes for their championship season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the Sevier County High School Bearettes basketball team upon winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class 4A state championship and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.